

SKITCH GRIP

BOODLE

EPISODE 11 — PRIVATE BOODLE





THERE IS A
PLACE BETWEEN
THE PLACES.

A CITY THAT LEANS
WHERE IT SHOULD
NOT, AND RISES
WHERE IT CANNOT.

A CITY OF
DREAMS, AND OF
NIGHTMARES.

IN THAT CITY
THERE IS A
DETECTIVE.

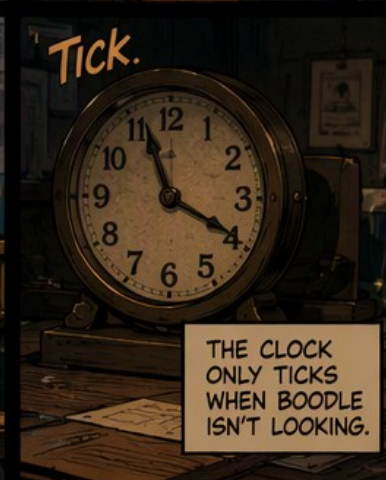
THEY CALL HIM BOODLE.

SOME CALL HIM A LEGEND.
OTHERS CALL HIM A THREAT.
ALL CALL HIM...

**THE CITY'S MOST
FEARED INVESTIGATOR.**

DETECTIVE
BOODLE
PRIVATE INVESTIGATOR

INQUIRIES
WELCOME*
"IF YOU DARE."



BOODLE & GRIP
INVESTIGATIONS
— SPECIAL CASES —

DETECTIVE BOODLE, I
TRUST YOU UNDERSTAND
THE GRAVITY OF THIS.

THE MIDNIGHT BELL.

OLD AS THE BUILDING ITSELF.
POLISHED EVERY MORNING
BY MY OFFICE.
RUNG ONCE EACH MIDNIGHT—
AUDIBLE TO EVERY TENANT,
REGARDLESS OF FLOOR.

VANISHED.
WITHOUT A TRACE.

A SYMBOL OF ORDER.
TRADITION. UNITY.

WITHOUT IT,
WE DESCEND INTO
CHAOS. CONFUSION.
ANARCHY.

I HOPE YOU'LL ACCEPT
THESE COURTESY BISCUITS
AS A TOKEN OF MY
APPRECIATION.

SO, DETECTIVE...
DO YOU TRULY
UNDERSTAND
THE SERIOUSNESS
OF THE MATTER?

...SLIDE

...SEARCH...
...SEARCH...

MM-HMM.
GOOD.

CHEW
CHEW

I UNDERSTAND
PERFECTLY.



AN IMPOSSIBLE CRIME,
IN AN IMPOSSIBLE PLACE.



THE MIDNIGHT BELL
IS GONE.
GRIP WILL PRESERVE
THE SCENE.
EVERY DETAIL
MATTERS.



THE CULPRIT
WAS CLOSE.
VERY CLOSE.
WITHIN... ONE
TINY HOP!



AND THIS
TINY CRUMB
CONFIRMS IT.



RELAX, GRIP!
THAT WAS A
FORENSIC TEST.

TASTE,
TEXTURE,
MOISTURE
CONTENT—
CLASSIC.



IN DREAMS, EVEN THE SMALLEST THINGS
LEAVE THEIR MARK.
GRIP WILL FIND THE TRUTH.
EVEN IF BOODLE EATS IT FIRST.

TO BE CONTINUED...

CASE FILE 0421-BOODLE
THE MIDNIGHT LOBBY
IMPOSSIBLE INCIDENT

- LOCKED DOOR
- NO FOOTSTEPS
- SILENCED BELL
- ELEVATOR ESCAPE
- BEFORE MIDNIGHT

Culprit remains
at large.

ALLOW ME
TO RECONSTRUCT
THE CRIME WITH ABSOLUTE
DRAMATIC CONFIDENCE!

OBSERVE!



THE TRUTH, AS ONLY BOODLE CAN SEE IT.

11:57 PM



THE DOOR WAS
LOCKED.
YET THEY ENTERED.

11:56 PM



THEY CROSSED
THE LOBBY WITHOUT
TOUCHING THE FLOOR.

11:54 PM



THEY SILENCED
THE BELL WITHOUT
A SOUND.

11:52 PM



THEY ESCAPED
THROUGH THE ELEVATOR
BEFORE MIDNIGHT.



TIME RAN BACKWARD.
FLOORS THAT DON'T EXIST.
PHYSICS BENT.
REALITY COMPLIED.



EVEN THE UMBRELLA
DEFIED
GRAVITY.



WAIT.
THE FOOTPRINT
IS SMALLER
THAN BOODLE'S
OWN PAW.



EXACTLY, GRIP!
AND THAT
MAKES THEM
EVEN **MORE**
DANGEROUS!



...HOW DOES
THAT LOGIC
EVEN WORK?

BECAUSE ONLY
A CULPRIT OF
TREMENDOUS SKILL,
RESOLVE, AND—
DARE I SAY—
MALEVOLENCE...



...COULD PULL OFF
THE IMPOSSIBLE
SO EFFORTLESSLY!
THIS WAS NO ORDINARY
THIEF, GRIP!

**THIS WAS A
MASTER OF
THE ABSURD!**

THEREFORE,
MY CONCLUSION
REMAINS
UNCHANGED!
THE CULPRIT IS—
**STILL AT
LARGE!**



UNTIL NEXT TIME, THE TRUTH REMAINS... WELL, FLEXIBLE. 



SECOND FLOOR KITCHEN
3:17 A.M.
IN A DREAM



CASE FILE: THE VANISHING BELL
STATUS: DREAM UNDER INVESTIGATION



THE FLOUR TRAIL LEADS FROM THE DREAM KITCHEN INTO THE DUMBWAITER CORRIDOR.

PAW PRINTS

DRAG MARKS

SKID

HMM...

THE PATCH...
IT FITS ME
PERFECTLY.

WHOEVER DID
THIS HAS BEEN
IMPERSONATING
ME.

DING!

?!

POOF!

TCH...
SKITCH...

I CAN'T
EVER CATCH
A BREAK...

YO! I HEARD
THERE WAS A
MYSTERY AND
A PASTRY!

**COULDN'T
MISS THAT!**

★

SKITCH: 1
GRIP: 0
BOODLE: STILL
PLUMP & DEDUCTING.

FOURTH FLOOR:
WORKSHOP CORRIDOR

I SAW OUR SUSPECT
ON THE FOURTH FLOOR.
I WATCHED THEM CARRY
A **ROUND BRASS OBJECT**
DOWN THE HALL.



THEY WERE TALL.

THEN SHORT.

THEY HAD A CAPE.

MAYBE THEY
WERE CRAWLING.

DEFINITELY
HUMMING.



WHY DIDN'T
YOU STOP
THEM?

THEY LOOKED
BUSY.



PFFFFFT.

A SIGN!
FROM THE
PNEUMATIC
SPIRIT!

TO THE
STEAM
FINGER!
FOLLOW!



Grip's Dream Workshop

EVERYTHING IN ITS PLACE.

LOOK AT THIS.

A SINGLE PART MISSING IN AN OCEAN OF ORDER.

THAT BELL IS PRECISELY THE SIZE AND WEIGHT TO FIT TEMPORARILY INSIDE THE TEST PULLEY HOUSING.

IT'S NOT JUST MISSING.

IT'S USEFUL.

DUMBWAITER REPAIR MODEL
TYPE: PULLEY LIFT - MARK VII

MISSING: PULLEY BELL (Ø 6.4 cm / 215 g)

SPECIFICATIONS

LOAD CAPACITY	120 kg
TEST WEIGHT	100 kg
PULLEY BELL	Ø 6.4 cm / 215 g
HOUSING ID	Ø 6.5 cm
TOLERANCE	+0.05 cm

MAINTENANCE LOG
LAST CHECK: 3 DAYS AGO
NEXT CHECK: 4 DAYS FROM NOW

EVERY TOOL. EVERY PART. EVERY TIME.

A PLACE. A PURPOSE. A RECORD.

PULLEYS

OOH!

WHAT'S THIS?

ZIIIIIP!

SPRING-LOADED MEASURING TAPE
MODEL: FLX-3000

WHICH MEANS SOMEONE TOOK IT FOR A REASON.

NOT INNOCENCE.

INTENT.

WEEEEEE!

YANK!

FWIP!

...!

THUD!

AN ASSASSINATION ATTEMPT!
I DEMAND JUSTICE!

VICTIM: BOODLE
WITNESS: TAPE
WEAPON: UNKNOWN

BOODLE.

IT'S A MEASURING TAPE.

NOT A SNAKE.

SAYS YOU, CONSPIRATOR.

WORKSHOP LAW #47

ANY TOOL CAN BE A WEAPON IN THE WRONG PAWS.

IN ORDER, WE DREAM. IN CHAOS, WE LEARN.



THE CASE OF
THE ESCAPING
BISCUIT
PART 7



THE LANDING
KEEPS
REPEATING.



THE WEATHER
KEEPS CHANGING.



THE PORTRAITS
KEEP WATCHING.



AT ONE POINT,
THE STAIRS GO
THROUGH BOODLE'S
OWN OFFICE.



SAME LANDING.



THE LIGHTHOUSE
FINALLY FINDS US.



A BRASS REFLECTION.

A TORN SCRAP
OF CLOTH.

AND A SINGLE,
UNTOUCHED
BISCUIT.



BOODLE APPROACHES
WITH EXTREME CAUTION.

TIP...
TIP...



CIRCLES IT.



SNIFFS IT.

SNIFF
SNIFF



THEN, WITHOUT WARNING—

POUNCE!



DEVOURS!



...ARE YOU
SERIOUS?



THE BISCUIT WAS
ATTEMPTING ESCAPE.

I PREVENTED
A CRIME.



Boodle

PRIVATE EYE

ANOTHER
NIGHT. ANOTHER
MYSTERY.

ANOTHER ROOFTOP.

A SHADOW...
A CASE!
I'M ON IT.

NOBODY
OUTRUNS
BOODLE!

THE CHASE
IS ON!

ACROSS
VENTS!

OVER
LINES!

AROUND
COOPS!

ALONG
LEDGES!

A FLUTTERING
FLAP!

A WAYWARD
HAT!

A GLINT OF
LIGHT!

MY OWN
BELT?!

The
CUMULUS
HOTEL
NO VACANCY

THE ESCAPE!

A DROP!

CLANG!

EVIDENCE
FOUND!

A CLOSER
LOOK...

...A
SOUP-POT
LID?

NOT WHAT I
WAS EXPECTING.

BUT STILL...

A DETECTIVE
TAKES PRIDE
IN ALL FINDS!

BEHOLD!

OFFICIAL
SOUP-POT
LID OF
JUSTICE!

CASE CLOSED?

WHO CARES!

LET'S
PLAY!

ANOTHER NIGHT.

ANOTHER ROOFTOP.

ANOTHER
ADVENTURE.

THAT'S THE REAL
MYSTERY—AND THE
BEST KIND.



DREAM-CAST TOWN
PAST MIDNIGHT

The
SNOOZE
HOTEL

I WAS CARRYING
A POT LID, SOME CLOTHS,
A BROKEN PULLEY, THREE KEYS,
AND A MIDNIGHT SANDWICH.

...AND MAYBE REPAIRING
SEVERAL THINGS NOBODY
HAD SCHEDULED TIME FOR.

DEFINE
"MAYBE."

SWING
SWING



INTERROGATION ROOM 3B
ONE WINDOW. NO MERCY.

YOU EXPECT US TO BELIEVE
YOU JUST WANDERED AROUND
TOWN ALL NIGHT WITH A POT LID
AND A SANDWICH, FIXING THINGS
NOBODY ASKED YOU TO FIX?

MOTIVE?
OPPORTUNITY?
SNACK?

SWING
SWING



I... JUST CAN'T STAND
SEEING THINGS FALL APART
IF I CAN HELP IT.

NO ONE'S GOT
TIME ANYMORE.

SO I DO.



I BELIEVE HIM.

I'VE SEEN THE CLOCK TOWER
PULLEY. HE DIDN'T HAVE TO
FIX THAT. NOBODY WOULD'VE
KNOWN FOR WEEKS.



UNSCHEDULED
REPAIRS (THIS WEEK)

- Clock Tower Pulley
- Dream-Duct Vent (3rd Floor)
- Neon Sign - Snooze Hotel (Flicker)
- Loose Chimney Brick - Main St.
- Squeaky Floorboard - Library
- Water Drip - Mayor's Office
- Loose Handrail - Overlook Bridge
- Vending Machine (Lemonade)
- Loose Bulletin Board - Town Hall
- Streetlamp 7B (Buzzing)
- ...and more.

POT LID
(MULTI-PURPOSE)

CLOTHS
(CLEAN & DRY...ISH)

BROKEN
PULLEY

THREE KEYS
(NO ONE MISSES
THE THIRD ONE)

MIDNIGHT
SANDWICH
(IMPORTANT)



HMM.

EXPLAIN
"DREAM-DUCT
VENT (3RD FLOOR)."



YOU LIST
EVERYTHING.

EVEN THE
SMALL THINGS.

THAT TAKES
A CERTAIN KIND OF
PERSON.



I DON'T DO IT
FOR THANKS.

I JUST... LIKE
THIS TOWN.

EVEN WHEN IT
FORGETS TO TAKE
CARE OF ITSELF.



HMPH.

NOT GUILTY.

...BUT YOU'RE
ON PROBATION.

AND NEXT TIME,
MAKE IT A BETTER
SANDWICH.



YOU REALLY
BELIEVE IN HIM,
DON'T YOU?

YEAH.

SOMEONE'S GOTTA.

JUST DOING
MY SHIFT.

QUIET SHIFT.

THE GOOD
KIND.

SOME HEROES
DON'T WEAR CAPES.
SOME WEAR
TOOL BELTS AND
WORK IN THE DARK
SO OTHERS CAN
DREAM IN THE LIGHT.





TO BE CONTINUED...

EMPLOYEE
HANDBOOK

CASE FILE
THE MIDNIGHT BELL

CLASSIFIED

I DON'T
LIKE THIS.

THERE!
THE MIDNIGHT BELL—
IT'S GETTING
AWAY!

DREAMS DON'T
PLAY BY THE
RULES.

URGENT
DON'T
OPEN
THIS
FILE

BOTTOM
DRAWER
∞

THE CASE REMAINS UNSOLVED.
THE DREAM DEEPENS.
THE JOURNEY CONTINUES.